

CDN Incident Alert: 0109. TLP: GREEN**Date****Title** SK Stormwall: A Slovak company supports Russian information warfare 03/03/2026**Summary**

- Two Russian entrepreneurs registered a company in Bratislava, which is part of the group providing technical solutions for the Russian disinformation apparatus, violating sanctions.
- Safe Value serves as the infrastructure operator and domain registrar for many Russian websites, while the Slovak StormWall provides DDoS protection, with these companies having close infrastructural links.
- A StormWall company connected to Russian entities has been registered in Slovakia since 2017.
- Doxing and intimidation of Ukrainian and foreign soldiers in Ukraine, civilians in Ukraine and Central Europe (Slovakia, Poland, Hungary), scams including luring personal information of missing persons from their relatives to then be posted online, through websites: Wartears contains data on 125,000 Ukrainian veterans, and was launched in 2022, ForeignCombatants is a databased of foreign mercenaries and volunteers, created by the Rybar and Vatfor Telegram channels
- Domain hosting and providing technical infrastructure to Telegram channels through Safe Value: Rybar (1.2 million subscribers on Telegram, a pro-Russian channel, posting military reports and coordinates of Ukrainian Armed Forces), ForeignCombatants (a pro-Russian Wikipedia of doxing, including profiles of mayors of Central European capitals that visited Kyiv)
- Submit Stormwall for an investigation for inclusion in the EU sanctions list

Incident

Two Russian entrepreneurs, Ramil Khantimirov and Alexei Shiyan, registered a company in Bratislava, StormWall s.r.o, which is part of the group providing technical solutions for the Russian disinformation apparatus. StormWall was used by the operations Wartears and ForeignCombatants.

The Wartears website collects personal information of Ukrainian soldiers and their families and shares it online, while ForeignCombatants serves as Wikipedia-like website for doxing. Wartears and ForeignCombatants were both created within the same seven days in 2022 are hosted by the same IP-address by Seychelles-based Safe Value Limited, whose only route out to the internet was through Moscow-based Storm Networks and Bratislava-based StormWall s.r.o until recently. The two doxing websites were two of multiple pro-Russian websites operated by Stormwal in Bratislava, and by an extension, Safe Value. However, after the [publication](#) of an investigation by us (FRONTSTORY, ICJK and VSquare), there was a change in the technical connection between the two companies.

Russian Storm Systems, one of the companies connected to StormWall, also hosts NewsFront, a sanctioned Russian site operating in a dozen European countries (previous investigations [1](#), [2](#)).

The rybar[.]ru domain, owned by sanctioned [entities](#), has their domain hosting providing from Safe Value since 2022. Rybar[.]ru, ForeignCombatants and the website belonging to Safe Value Limited all use servers managed by Stormwall, in violation with EU sanctions.

One of the IP addresses currently registered to Safe Value has for years been used to host websites associated with disinformation operations. It is notably linked to the “Pravda Network,” which includes domains such as dnr-pravda[.]ru, gazeta-dnr[.]ru, podvig-dnr[.]ru, and dnr-hotline[.]ru.

On June 8, 2022, Russia’s MFA posted on their Facebook that the Foreigncombatants database is created by two Telegram channels: Rybar and Vatfor. Ukrainian media have reported that Telegram channels Rybar and Vatfor are linked to Russia’s military intelligence service.

According to data from official Slovak records, the owners of Stormwall declare permanent residence in Bratislava as of May 2025.

The provider enables Stalking, doxing, personal information sharing in order to enforce psychological pressure, create atmosphere of fear and weaken morale. One case identified involved a woman being asked for money or otherwise her relative who was in captivity would spend the night outside.

Systemic violation assessment

Besides providing domains for doxing websites, by they also provided services to sanctioned actors. Since Stormwall, based in the EU is freely operating and providing technical infrastructure to websites which are able to bypass EU sanctions

Narrative

Case covers infrastructure for actors spreading harmful narratives.

Impact and Outcome

Reach: Stormwall provides a route to the internet for websites that doxed (foreign) soldiers in Ukraine, resulting in sharing private information online in complete lists, intimidation of families and additional psychological pressure, and even asking for ransom in exchange for information. Additionally, also mayors of Central European capitals were included in these websites ([source](#)).

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ForeignCombatants is a databased of foreign mercenaries and volunteers.

Domain hosting and providing technical infrastructure to Telegram channels through Safe Value: Rybar (1.2 million subscribers on Telegram, a pro-Russian channel, posting military reports and coordinates of Ukrainian Armed Forces), ForeignCombatants (a pro-Russian Wikipedia of doxing, including profiles of mayors of Central European capitals that visited Kyiv)

Outcome: The continued operations of domains/Telegram channels

Key Objectives and Behaviours

Objective 1: Facilitate state propaganda - The contents of websites hosted by StormWall framed Ukrainian and foreign soldiers using pro-Russian narratives

Objective 2: Cause harm - Hosting the domains directly hurt soldiers and civilians

[T0152.003: Website hosting platform](#) - The Slovakia-based company Stormwall provides services to already sanctioned Russian domains and facilitates a platform for Russian information warfare actors.

Recommendations and Actions Taken

Actions Taken: Published an investigation in collaboration with ICCT, organized a webinar about the investigation. We asked StormWall, as well as Ramil Khantimirov, to tell us about the relationship between the parties we described. By the time this text was published, we had not received a response.

Our desired impact would be to start an investigation in Stormwall for eligibility for sanctions

Report	Threat Actor	Authors	Platforms	FIMI assessment
Link	Russia	Anastasiia Morozova, Alicja Pawłowska, Anna Gielewska (FRONTSTORY.pl) Collaboration: Daniel Flis (FRONTSTORY), Tamara Kaňuchová (VSquare), Tomáš Madleňák, Karin Kőváry Sólmos (ICJK)	Domain hosting of websites and Telegram channels	High Certainty

Evidence

<https://vsquare.org/doxing-private-data-russian-weapon-ukraine-central-europe-poland-slovakia->

attacks/

<https://www.domaintools.com/resources/blog/rdap-and-bgp-in-investigative-journalism/>

<https://icct.nl/project/anti-dox-identifying-evaluating-and-countering-disinformation-times-war>

<https://icct.nl/publication/testimonies-victims-russian-extremist-doxing>

<https://icct.nl/publication/doxing-literature-review>